DESK CLOCK

Ian Woodford recreates an antique desk clock in his own design

I've had a fascination for clocks for many years and this project is my interpretation of an old desk clock I saw in a local antique shop. The turning involves straightforward faceplate and spindle work. Care in marking out and accurate copying for the two pillars, will result in a clock that will find pride of place on any desk or shelf within your home.

I prefer a close-grained wood for projects like this, with a pleasant but not too pronounced grain pattern. For me, bubinga (*Guibourtia demeusei*) meets these criteria, but you can use whatever you choose.

The project is based around a clock insert with a bezel diameter of 60mm and these can be found quite easily on the internet. For this project I start with the base and work my way up to the pillars, the clock barrel and then the two supporting pins that fix the barrel to the pillars. Only basic turning tools are required.

I realize that projects like this take time and accuracy but when finished, this one should give you immense satisfaction. Let's get into the workshop and have some fun!

EQUIPMENT USED

Bubinga blanks (or wood of your choice)
Base – 130 x 30mm
Barrel – 80 x 30mm
Pillars – 180 x 20 x 20mm
Pins – 90 x 12 x 12mm
Four jaw chuck
Bandsaw
Spindle roughing gouge
10mm fingernail gouge
6mm and 10mm bowl gouges
Skew
Thin parting tool
Jacobs chuck
5mm and 8mm drill bits
Vernier callipers
Steel rule
Abrasive papers in grits to 400
Sanding sealer
Carnauba wax
Buffing wheel
White wood glue
Paper towel
60mm clock insert

PHOTOGRAPHS BY IAN WOODFORD

IAN WOODFORD

Ian spent his working life selling with a large pharmaceutical company covering a huge area in Australia and also in the UK. He has been turning for many years and since taking early retirement, has developed his skills and enthusiasm. He supplies various craft shops, exhibits at craft shows and has sold at the prestigious London Pen Show, although he now only makes on a commission basis. Ian belongs to two turning clubs in Hampshire and has demonstrated to members on a number of occasions. He has a dedicated workshop and enjoys new projects and challenges.

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